

NAVIGATOR KIDS

SHELLY'S WAVE RIDER GUIDE

A Field Guide for Ocean Explorers

EXPLORER NAME: _____

DIVE DATE: _____

For kids who feel things as big as the ocean!

The Story of Shelly

Meet Shelly.

*Shelly is a Sea Turtle who loves the ocean. She loves the bright coral reefs and the warm sun. But sometimes, the ocean gets **TOO LOUD** and **TOO BUSY**.*

When the waves get big, Shelly feels like she is spinning in a washing machine.

Her heart beats fast. Her shell feels tight. Her brain feels 'Fizzy'.

*She wants to hide in her shell, but she really wants to stay and play. She needs to learn how to **RIDE** the waves instead of letting them crash on her!*

YOUR TURN:

Draw what a 'Stormy Day' looks like inside your head. Is it messy scribbles? Lightning bolts? A giant wave?

Mission: Surf the Wave

Shelly is feeling fizzy! She needs a Wave Rider (YOU) to help her find calm.

STEP 1: PLAY THE GAME

Open 'Wave Rider Adventure' on the computer.

Help Shelly check the wave, breathe like a starfish, and shake it out.

Did you help Shelly?

☐ YES! I checked the wave size!

☐ YES! Shelly feels calm!

Now, let's learn how to surf YOUR waves.

TOOL 1: THE WAVE CHECK

Not every wave is a Tsunami. We need to measure it first.

HOW BIG IS IT?

1. CALM	Tiny ripples. Easy peasy.
2. WIGGLY	A little bumpy. I can handle it.
3. CRASH!	Big splash! I need my tools!
4. TSUNAMI	Too big! I need a grown-up!

If it's a Tsunami, go find your Safe Person (The Lifeguard)!

TOOL 2: STARFISH BREATH

When the wave crashes, we need an anchor. Your hand is your anchor.

TRACE THE STAR:

- Spread your hand wide like a Starfish.
- Trace UP your thumb... Breathe IN.
- Trace DOWN your thumb... Breathe OUT.
- Do all 5 fingers until you float.

TRACE IT HERE:

Put your hand on this paper and trace it with a crayon while you breathe.

TOOL 3: SHAKE THE JELLY

Sometimes the 'Fizzy' feeling gets stuck in your body. You have to shake it out!

THE JELLYFISH DANCE:

1. Wiggle your fingers.

2. Wiggle your toes.

3. Shake your whole body like a wobbly Jellyfish!

4. FREEZE! (Do you feel lighter?)

LIFeguard MANUAL

The Science of The Wave

1. Emotional Granularity (The Wave Check)

Anxiety feels like 'everything is wrong.' Scaling the problem (1-4) engages the prefrontal cortex and reduces the amygdala's alarm response.

2. Somatosensory Anchoring (Starfish Breath)

Asking a panicked child to 'just breathe' often fails. Tracing the hand provides tactile feedback that grounds them in the present moment.

3. Somatic Discharge (Shake It Out)

Stress hormones (cortisol) get trapped in the body. Physical movement 'completes the stress cycle,' allowing the body to return to safety.

SURFER'S POCKET KIT

Instructions: Cut these out and keep them in your pocket.

■ WAVE CHECK

1. Ripple (Easy)
2. Wiggly (Okay)
3. CRASH (Use Tools!)
4. TSUNAMI (Help!)

■ STARFISH

Trace UP (Inhale)
Trace DOWN (Exhale)
Do all 5 fingers.

CERTIFIED WAVE RIDER

This certifies that

**Has learned the secrets of the
Ocean
and can surf the big emotions.**

"I am braver than the waves!"